

物の 哀れ

MONO NO AWARE

A WORD

Mono no aware

It translates, roughly, as "the pathos of things" — the gentle, bittersweet awareness that everything is passing, and that its impermanence is precisely what makes it beautiful. The cherry blossom is treasured not in spite of falling in a week but *because* it does. The autumn leaf is loveliest the moment before it lets go.

It is the deepest current under the whole Japandi aesthetic. It is why we prize the worn over the new, the handmade over the perfect, the dried stem over the plastic flower — because they carry time visibly, and honour the fact that nothing stays. A

"Things are beautiful because they pass. Keep the ones that show it."

home built on *mono no aware* is not trying to look finished forever. It is trying to be beautiful now, while now is here.

